Charles I and the Civil War

CHARLES I, 1625-1649

Crown against Parliament

Percorso 1 · Divine right

1 DIVINE RIGHT

kings chosen by God;

absolute power;

total obedience

▼ **his man:**

4 WILLIAM LAUD

Archbishop of Canterbury;

persecutes the Puritans;

later executed

▼ **careful:**

7 COMMON MISTAKES

Royalists = Puritans (✗)

Short = Long (✗)

1628 = 1629 (✗)

Percorso 2 · Taxes and church

2  **TAXES AND CHURCH**

taxes without consent

of Parliament; obey the

Church of England

▼ **then**

5 **PERSONAL RULE**

1629: Parliament shut;

11 years as a despot

(until 1640)

▼ **war**

8 

CIVIL WAR 1642-49

Royalists v Roundheads;

Cromwell's Ironsides win

Marston Moor, Naseby

Percorso 3 · Petition of right

3 PETITION OF RIGHT

1628: no taxes without

Parliament; no prison

without a good reason

▼ later

6 THE 1640 PARLIAMENTS

Short (a month), then

Long: refuses funds,

reduces king's power

▼ end:

9 1649

king refuses the court;

death warrant signed;

beheaded in January

Connessioni chiave

→ The king (1) wants power and taxes without Parliament (2); Laud (4) helps him.

→ After 11 years alone (5), the Long Parliament (6) goes against him.

→ The Civil War (8) ends with the king beheaded in January 1649 (9).

Cromwell and the Commonwealth

THE COMMONWEALTH

1649-1660: England without a king

Percorso 1 · 1649: republic

1 **1649: REPUBLIC**

Commonwealth: a Republic;
monarchy and House of
Lords abolished

▼ then

4 **1653: PROTECTOR**

Cromwell closes
Parliament; Lord Protector
a military dictator

▼ careful:

7 **COMMON MISTAKES**

Rump = Lords (✗)
Dunbar = Naseby (✗)
Richard = Charles (✗)

Percorso 2 · Rump parliament

2  **RUMP PARLIAMENT**

until 1653: only
supporters of the Republic
sit in the Commons

▼ **ruling**

5 **THREE COUNTRIES**

he rules England,
Ireland and Scotland

▼ **then**

8 **1658**

Cromwell is succeeded
by his son Richard, who
abdicates after 8 months

Percorso 3 · 1650: reaction

3 1650: REACTION

Royalist reaction in Ireland and Scotland;

Dunbar: crushed

▼ so

6 1655: RISING

another Royalist rising;

Cromwell rules

through the army

▼ finally

9 THE END

the Republic falls apart; the monarchy

returns in 1660

Connessioni chiave

→ The Republic (1) is ruled by the Rump Parliament (2) until Cromwell closes it (4).

→ Cromwell, Lord Protector, rules three countries (5), then through the army (6).

→ In 1658 his son Richard (8) abdicates: the Republic falls apart (9).

The Restoration

THE RESTORATION

1660-1688: Charles II and James II

Percorso 1 · Charles ii

1 CHARLES II

king 1660-1685;

first Parliament almost

all Royalists

▼ after him

4 JAMES II

1685-1688; brother

of Charles II;

a Catholic king

▼ careful:

7 COMMON MISTAKES

Whigs = monarchy (✗)

Test Act = 1689 (✗)

James II Protestant (✗)

Percorso 2 · Parliament's aim

2  **PARLIAMENT'S AIM**

restore king and
Parliament; the king
can never rule alone

▼ **parties**

5 **THE WHIGS**

anti-Catholic;
want to limit the
powers of the monarch

▼ **and**

8 **THE TORIES**

support the monarchy

3  **THE CHURCH**

the Church of England

is brought back

by Parliament

▼ **law**

6 **TEST ACT 1673**

public office only for

Protestants who accept

the king as Church head

▼ **end:**

9 **AFTER JAMES**

William of Orange comes;

James II flees abroad:

Glorious Revolution

Connessioni chiave

→ Parliament (2) restores king (1) and Church (3), but the king cannot rule alone.

→ Whigs (5) limit the monarch; Tories (8) support him; the Test Act (6).

→ The Catholic James II (4) flees abroad (9).

William, Mary and Anne

AFTER 1688

from William and Mary to Queen Anne

Percorso 1 · William and mary

1 WILLIAM AND MARY

1689-1702; William of Orange, Protestant, *husband of Mary Stuart*

▼ after

4 GLORIOUS REVOLUTION

they arrive; James II flees abroad; they are *crowned king and queen*

▼ careful:

7 COMMON MISTAKES

Bill of Rights = Union (✗)

1701 = 1707 (✗)

Utrecht = Culloden (✗)

Percorso 2 · Bill of rights 1689

2 BILL OF RIGHTS 1689

king's power limited:

parliamentary

constitutional monarchy

▼ also

5 TOLERATION ACT

1689: Dissenters get

freedom of worship

▼ and

8 ACT OF SETTLEMENT

1701: only Protestants

can be heirs to

the throne

Percorso 3 · Queen anne

3  **QUEEN ANNE**

1702-1714; Mary's sister

1707: Act of Union:

England + Scotland

▼ **war**

6 **SPANISH SUCCESSION**

England, Holland, Prussia

v France, Spain, Portugal

England wins battles

▼ **ends with**

9 **UTRECHT 1713**

Britain gets Gibraltar

and Minorca; trade with

Spanish colonies

Connessioni chiave

→ William and Mary (1) arrive: Glorious Revolution (4), Bill of Rights (2).

→ Toleration Act (5) and Act of Settlement (8): freedom of worship, Protestant heirs.

→ Anne (3) wins the Spanish Succession war (6); Utrecht 1713 (9).

The Augustan Age

THE AUGUSTAN AGE

George I (1714) and George II

Percorso 1 · George i

1 GEORGE I

1714; Elector of
Hanover; proclaimed
after Queen Anne

▼ first

4 WALPOLE

Sir Robert Walpole
(1676-1745): the first
Prime Minister

▼ careful:

7 COMMON MISTAKES

George I = George II (✗)
Culloden = Dunbar (✗)
Pitt = Walpole (✗)

Percorso 2 · Prime minister

2 PRIME MINISTER

link between ministers and king: George I

didn't speak English

▼ opposed by

5 JACOBITES

support James II's son James and grandson

Charles; 1715 fails

▼ ends at

8 CULLODEN 1746

the last Jacobite rising (1745) is

defeated in Scotland

Percorso 3 · George ii

3 **GEORGE II**

1727-1760; wars

for colonies

and trade

▼ **wars:**

6 

THREE WARS

Jenkins' Ear 1739;

Austrian Succession 1740-48

Seven Years' War 1756-63

▼ **biggest:**

9 

SEVEN YEARS' WAR

global war; Pitt the

Elder; Britain stronger

in India and Canada

Connessioni chiave

→ George I (1) did not speak English: so the Prime Minister (2, 4) was created.

→ The Jacobites (5) rose in 1715 and 1745; they lost at Culloden (8).

→ Under George II (3) Britain fought for colonies (6): the Seven Years' War (9).

Puritan literature

PURITAN LITERATURE

1625-1660: Puritans in power

Percorso 1 · Features

1 FEATURES

reflective tone; moral

lessons; religious

fervor; afterlife

▼ first

4 PURITAN POETS

purification of society;

salvation, predestination;

didactic; the Bible

▼ careful:

7 COMMON MISTAKES

Donne = Puritan (✗)

conceit = rhyme (✗)

Milton = metaphysical (✗)

2 TWO TYPES

17th-century poetry:
Puritan poets and
Metaphysical poets

▼ second

5 METAPHYSICAL POETS

philosophical concepts;
dissatisfaction;
love and religion

▼ uses

8 CONCEIT

extended metaphor:
surprising comparison
of two different things

Percorso 3 · John milton

3 JOHN MILTON

best represents the
poetry of the century;
a fervent Puritan

▼ **masterpiece**

6 PARADISE LOST

1667: epic poem on
the fall and redemption
of mankind

▼ **famous:**

9 JOHN DONNE

love and man-God;
love: spiritual and
physical; not Petrarch

Connessioni chiave

→ Puritan literature (1) has two kinds of poets (2): Puritan (4), Metaphysical (5).

→ Metaphysical poets use conceits (8); the most famous is John Donne (9).

→ Milton (3) is the Puritan author of Paradise Lost (6).

John Milton

JOHN MILTON

1608-1674: Puritan poet

Percorso 1 · Life

1 LIFE

1608 London, Puritan
family; St Paul's
School; Cambridge

▼ then

4 POLITICS

supports Cromwell
and the Puritans;
blind by 1651

▼ careful:

7 COMMON MISTAKES

blind in 1608 (✗)
Areopagitica = poem (✗)
died in 1667 (✗)

Percorso 2 · First period

2 FIRST PERIOD

L'Allegro, Il Penseroso

(1631, after Petrarch)

Defensio 1651: Cromwell

▼ **defends**

5 LIBERTIES

religious, civil, domestic;

press; Parliament;

divorce

▼ **later**

8 1660

fell from grace with

the Restoration; hid;

1664-74: poetry

Percorso 3 · Second period

3 SECOND PERIOD

pamphlets and prose;

Areopagitica (1644):

freedom of speech

▼ **finally**

6 THIRD PERIOD

blindness and poverty;

masterpiece:

Paradise Lost (1667)

▼ **ends:**

9 1674

he dies. A famous line:

"The mind is its own

place…" (Paradise Lost)

Connessioni chiave

→ A Puritan (1) who supported Cromwell (4) and defended freedom of speech (3, 5).

→ The Restoration (8) brought him poverty; blind, he wrote Paradise Lost (6).

→ Three periods: poems (2), prose (3), the masterpiece (6).

Paradise Lost: the plot

PARADISE LOST: PLOT

Genesis retold, 1667

Percorso 1 · Chained in hell

1 CHAINED IN HELL

the poem begins:

Satan and his friend

on a lake of fire

▼ then

4 THEY FREE THEMSELVES

and want to start

another war

against God

▼ careful:

7 COMMON MISTAKES

Adam eats first (✗)

Michael punishes (✗)

Satan stays in Hell (✗)

Percorso 2 · Beelzebub's idea

2 BEELZEBUB'S IDEA

corrupt mankind,
God's beloved
new creation

▼ so

5 THE SERPENT

Satan returns to Eden;
compliments Eve; he ate
the Tree's fruit

▼ then

8 EVE AND ADAM EAT

Eve eats; Adam is
horrified, but eats too:
fallen with her

3 GOD KNOWS

God knows at once

about the

disobedience

▼ **he punishes**

6 PUNISHMENT

the serpent must crawl;

Adam and Eve:

pain and death

▼ **but**

9 REDEMPTION

archangel Michael shows

the future of mankind;

they leave Eden

Connessioni chiave

→ In Hell Satan (1) frees himself (4); Beelzebub's idea (2) leads to the serpent (5).

→ Eve and Adam eat the fruit (8); God knows at once (3) and punishes them (6).

→ Michael shows a vision of redemption (9).

Paradise Lost: ideas

PARADISE LOST: IDEAS

themes, universe, Satan, style

Percorso 1 · Two paths

1 TWO PATHS

Satan: sin, punishment

Man: repentance,

hope of redemption

▼ themes

4 THEMES

disobedience, rebellion,

redemption, God's

grace and mercy

▼ careful:

7 COMMON MISTAKES

Satan chooses redemption (✗)

science-based universe (✗)

rhymed verse (✗)

Percorso 2 · Four realms

2 FOUR REALMS

Heaven (above), Hell (below), Chaos,

a young Earth

▼ **ranked by**

5 HIERARCHY

the Son, archangels, humans, animals,

devils (near to far)

▼ **written in**

8 STYLE

complex; allusions; archaic words; extended

similes; educated readers

Percorso 3 · Satan

3 SATAN

refuses God's superiority;

banished to Hell;

"Better to reign in Hell"

▼ then

6 HEROIC, THEN LOW

at first heroic: refuses

defeat; in the end

degradation, vanity

▼ meter:

9 METER

blank verse: unrhymed

iambic pentameters

(Marlowe, Shakespeare)

Connessioni chiave

→ Two moral paths (1): Satan chooses damnation; Adam and Eve, redemption.

→ The universe has four realms (2) and a hierarchy by closeness to God (5).

→ Satan (3, 6) looks heroic, then degraded; style (8) is complex; blank verse (9).

Overview

1625 TO PARADISE LOST

how the topics are connected

Percorso 1 · Civil war

1 

CIVIL WAR

Charles I, Divine Right;

Petition of Right 1628;

war 1642-49; beheaded

▼ then

4 **1689-1714**

Glorious Revolution;

Bill of Rights; Anne;

Union 1707; Utrecht

▼ see also:

7 **JOHN MILTON**

1608-1674; Puritan;

Areopagitica; blind;

Paradise Lost

Percorso 2 · Commonwealth

2 COMMONWEALTH

Republic 1649; Cromwell

Lord Protector 1653;

Richard 1658

▼ then

5 AUGUSTAN AGE

George I: Prime Minister;

Jacobites; Culloden;

Seven Years' War

Percorso 3 · The restoration

3 THE RESTORATION

Charles II 1660; Test Act

Whigs and Tories;

James II (Catholic)

▼ literature

6 PURITAN LITERATURE

Puritan and Metaphysical

poets; John Donne;

conceits

Da sapere per l'interrogazione

▼ for the oral exam

8 PARADISE LOST

Satan's rebellion; Eve and Adam eat; redemption
disobedience, rebellion, redemption; four realms;
Satan heroic then degraded; blank verse

Connessioni chiave

→ History: war (1), republic (2), Restoration (3), William, Anne (4), Georges (5).

→ Literature: Puritan and Metaphysical poets (6), then John Milton (7).

→ Milton's masterpiece is Paradise Lost (8). Dates: 1625, 1649, 1660, 1689, 1714.